Psychology2e_OpenStax

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Psychology 2e

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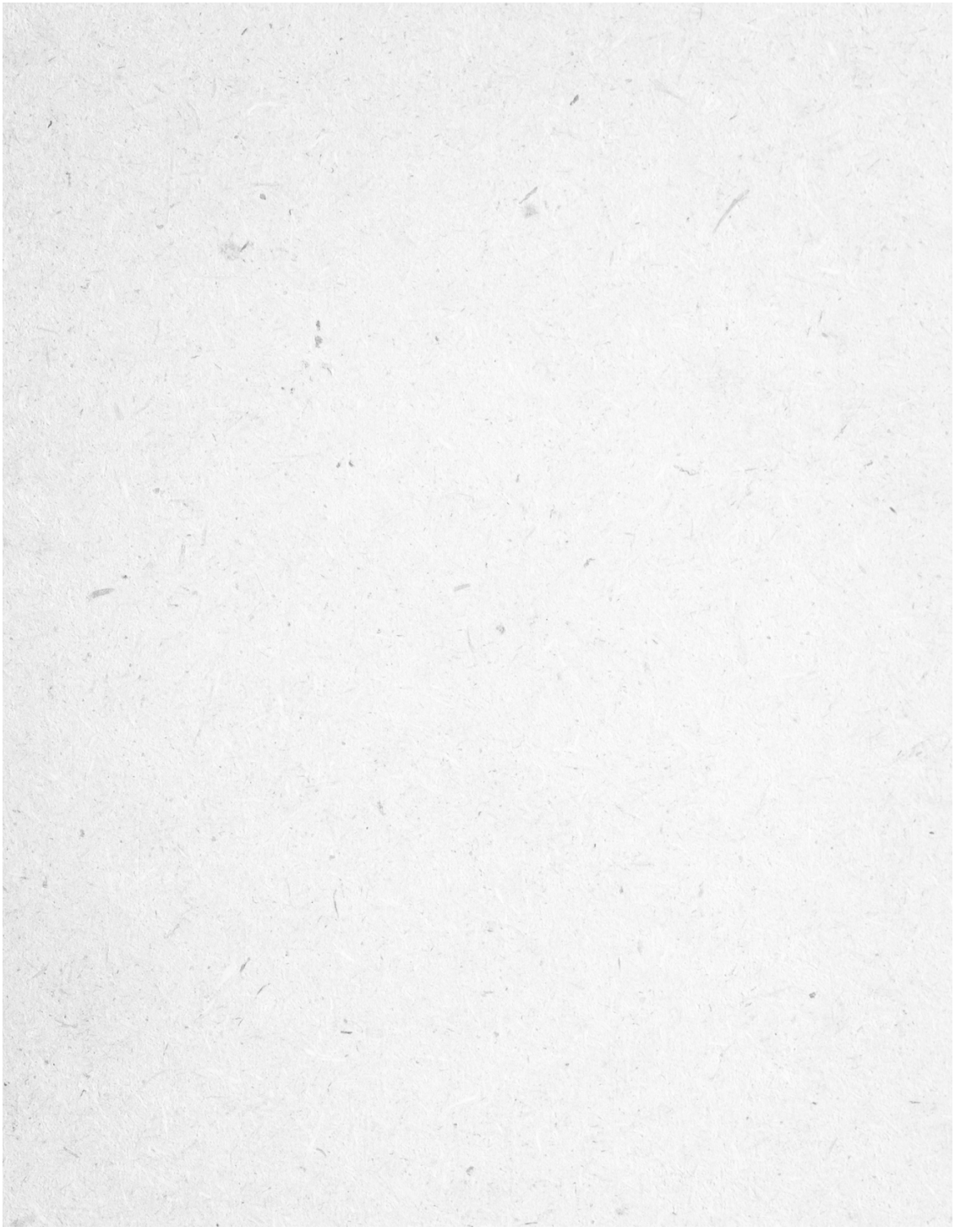
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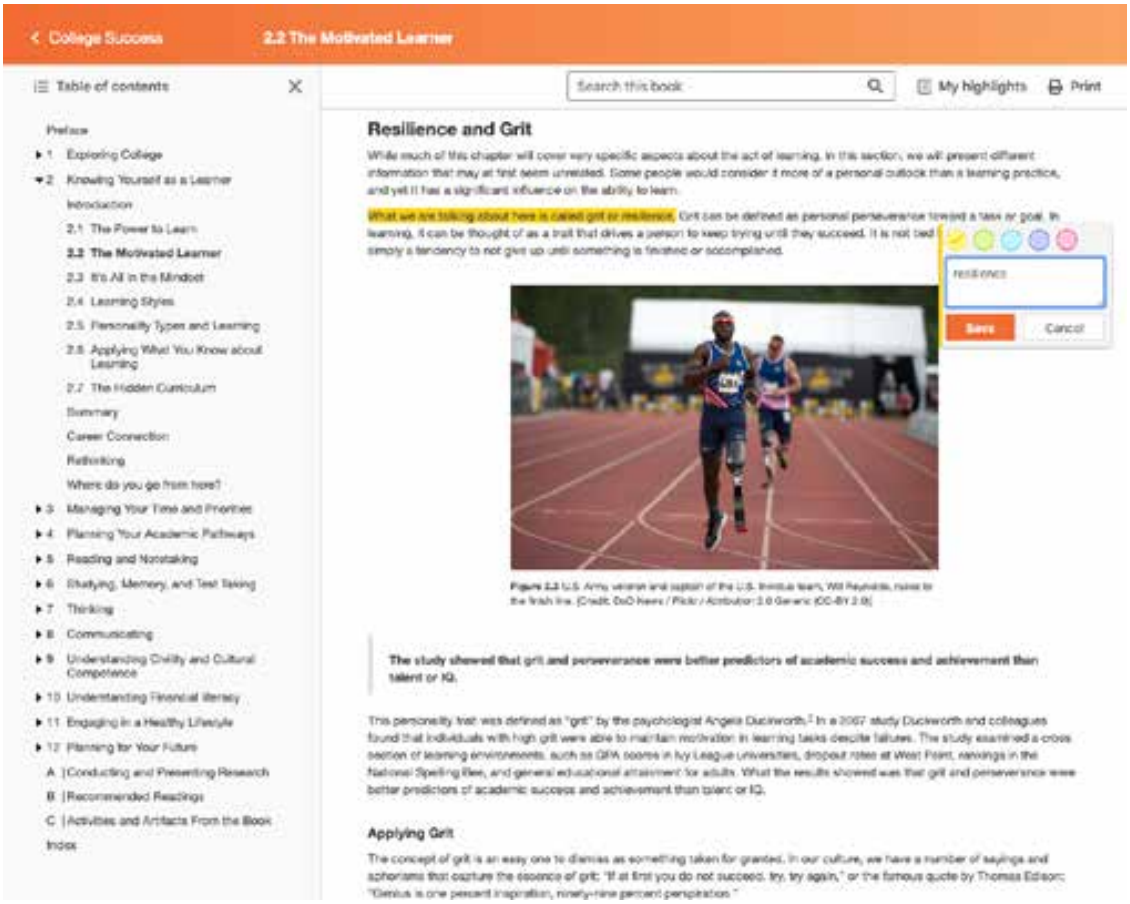
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College Success
2.2 The Motivated Learner
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Resilience and Grit
While much of this chapter will cover very specific aspects about the act of learning, in this section, we will present different information that may at first seem unrelated. Some people would consider it more of a personal outlook than a learning practice, and yet it has a significant influence on the ability to learn.
What we are talking about here is called grit or resilience. Grit can be defined as personal perseverance toward a task or goal. In learning, it can be thought of as a trait that drives a person to keep trying until they succeed. It is not tied to talent or IQ, but simply a tendency to not give up until something is finished or accomplished.
resilience
Save
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The study showed that grit and perseverance were better predictors of academic success and achievement than talent or IQ.
This personality trait was defined as "grit" by the psychologist Angela Duckworth.[1] In a 2007 study Duckworth and colleagues found that individuals with high grit were able to maintain motivation in learning tasks despite failures. The study examined a cross section of learning environments, such as GPA scores in Ivy League universities, dropout rates at West Point, rankings in the National Spelling Bee, and general educational attainment for adults. What the results showed was that grit and perseverance were better predictors of academic success and achievement than talent or IQ.
Applying Grit
The concept of grit is an easy one to dismiss as something taken for granted. In our culture, we have a number of sayings and aphorisms that capture the essence of grit: "If at first you do not succeed, try, try again," or the famous quote by Thomas Edison: "Genius is one percent inspiration, ninety-nine percent perspiration."


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